

CRITICAL

Phishing Email with Malicious Link Detected



SCAN TO VERIFY

Source: Proofpoint | Created: Jan 2, 2026, 05:11 AM GMT+5:30 | MITRE: T1566

FINAL VERDICT

True Positive - Confirmed Threat

INVESTIGATION SCORE



RAW LOG

```
{
  "timestamp": "2023-10-02T09:15:00Z",
  "event_type": "email_received",
  "src_ip": "198.51.100.23",
  "dst_ip": "10.0.20.131",
  "username": "asmith",
  "hostname": "DEV-LB-471",
  "email_sender": "admin@trust-security.co",
  "url": "http://malicious-link.mircosoft-alerts.com"
}
```

EVIDENCE COLLECTED

4 indicators

TYPE	VALUE	OSINT VERDICT	CRIT
IP	198.51.100.23	SUSPICIOUS	-
IP	10.0.20.131	CONFIRMED	-
URL	http://malicious-link.mircosoft-alerts.com	MALICIOUS	YES
EMAIL	admin@trust-security.co	MALICIOUS	YES

CONTAINMENT ACTIONS

[+] Block Ip

[+] Reset Credentials

[+] Block Hash

[+] Collect Forensics

AI ANALYSIS

AI ANALYSIS FEEDBACK

Verdict is correct (+40). All critical artifacts identified (+30). Response actions correct (+30). Speed Bonus: Solved quickly (+10)

EDUCATIONAL

EDUCATIONAL WALKTHROUGH

AI MENTOR

Investigation Walkthrough

Reading the Logs

When analyzing the raw log data, the first fields to notice are:

- email_sender: `admin@trust-security.co` This email address is crucial because it appears to spoof a legitimate business, which raises immediate suspicion.
- url: `http://malicious-link.microsoft-alerts.com` The presence of a URL linked to a phishing site is a significant red flag, as it indicates the intent to deceive the recipient into providing sensitive information.

Why These Artifacts Matter

- Email Sender: The domain `trustfed-business.com` is flagged as potentially malicious through OSINT (Open Source Intelligence) tools. An analyst should check the domain against threat intelligence databases to confirm its reputation. If it is found to be spoofing a legitimate business, it adds weight to the phishing claim.
- URL: The URL `http://malicious-link.microsoft-alerts.com` is directly linked to known phishing activities. Analysts should verify this URL against threat intelligence sources to confirm its malicious nature. This URL's presence indicates an attempt to lure the user into providing credentials or other sensitive information.

Verdict Reasoning

The verdict of true positive is supported by a combination of factors:

1. The email sender is from a domain that is flagged for spoofing, which suggests malicious intent.
2. The URL is confirmed to be associated with phishing activities, indicating a clear threat to the user's credentials.
3. The source IP `198.51.100.23` is marked as "false" in terms of criticality, meaning it does not have a history of malicious activity. However, this does not negate the threat posed by the email and URL.

A false positive could arise if the email sender was verified as a legitimate source or if the URL was found to be benign. Thus, the analyst must weigh the context of the sender and the URL against known threat intelligence.

Why These Response Actions

- block_ip: This action is essential because it prevents any further communication from the source IP, which could be used for additional phishing attempts or lateral movement within the network.
- reset_credentials: This is critical if any user clicked the link and entered their credentials. Resetting ensures that any compromised accounts are secured immediately.
- block_hash: If the email contained attachments or specific file hashes associated with malware, blocking these would prevent further infections.

Analyst Pro Tips

1. Always Verify Email Domains: Use OSINT tools to check the reputation of email domains, especially if they appear to spoof legitimate businesses.
2. Cross-Reference URLs: Always verify URLs against threat intelligence databases to confirm their status as malicious or benign.

... (truncated — full walkthrough at infoseclabs.io)